HEIRSTONE CONSULTING

INDUSTRIAL CITIES AND EXPORTS

The port is the cheap part

How industrial zones, ports and the cities around them build an export base in Africa, from Tanger Med and Kenitra to Sokhna, Nkok, Glo-Djigbé and Diamniadio



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SIX NUMBERS FROM THIS REPORT

3.4x
investment in Tanger Med's industrial platform for each dollar in its port complex, on the group's own split to 2024 (US$6.39bn against US$1.9bn), which does not allocate US$5.25bn of public money

-12%
vehicles handled at Tanger Med in 2025, a year in which its container traffic rose 8.4% to a record 11.1m TEU

US$33.1bn
investment attracted by SCZone's Sokhna zone in Egypt, the largest investment total in the benchmark, with more than 133,000 direct jobs across 547 projects

11,400+
jobs lost in Ethiopia's industrial parks after its eligibility for US trade preferences ended on 1 January 2022

420
homes delivered by October 2025 at Chrafate, a new town planned for 30,000; the commune of Tangier counted 1,275,428 residents in 2024

US$10-15k
exports per worker in Kenya's export processing zones, Gabon's Nkok zone and Kigali's special economic zone (Heirstone analysis)

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

Heirstone Consulting advises developers, investors, development finance institutions and governments across the Middle East and Africa on industrial, logistics and specialised real estate. This report uses public sources current in 2026: zone authority and developer disclosures, port statistics, census results, company releases and press reports citing them. Every figure is referenced in the exhibit sources and in the notes at the end.

Where we combine published figures to produce a new one, such as jobs per hectare or jobs per million dollars invested, the calculation is labelled Heirstone analysis and the inputs are shown. Local-currency figures carry a US dollar equivalent and the rate used.

Companion reports in this series cover trade corridors and logistics (*Where cargo stops*), worker housing (*Factories need beds*), agro-processing zones and mining towns.

READING THE EXHIBITS

Exhibits are numbered in page order. Each title states the finding; the line below gives the measure, unit and period, and the source line the issuer and date. The four types of export city defined in chapter 5 keep the same colours throughout.

Metro platform · Preference enclave · Feedstock zone · Platform in waiting

SUMMARY

Ports win the headlines. The money and the risk of an export city sit inland, in the industrial platform and the town around it.

We compiled public data on 31 export and industrial zones in 14 African countries, from Tangier to the Eastern Cape. The zones that export at scale combine an anchor exporter, a gateway within a short truck run and an existing city that absorbed the workforce. Trade preferences and raw-material bans can create a zone quickly and can empty one as fast.

1 **The quay took the smaller share of the capital.**
Tanger Med Group puts US$6.39bn of cumulative investment in its industrial platform and US$1.9bn in the port complex, though its sheet does not allocate US$5.25bn of public money. At Nador West Med the port is MAD 13.7bn of a MAD 51bn programme. SCZone's chairman puts port contracts since July 2022 at about US$1.5bn, against roughly US$16bn of investment attracted.

2 **Port traffic is a poor guide to the export base.**
In 2025 Tanger Med's container traffic rose 8.4% to 11.1m TEU while vehicles handled fell 12% and Stellantis exports through the port fell 26%. SCZone's chairman cites 5.6m TEU at East Port Said in 2026, up from 2.4m in 2024, beside an early-stage zone of about 2,000 jobs.

3 **Density and jobs per dollar separate the zones.**
Achieved density runs from about 2 jobs per hectare at Coega to 42-73 at Kenitra and 269 at Hawassa's peak. Inside SCZone, Sokhna has drawn US$33.1bn and more than 133,000 direct jobs, about 4 per US$1m, and Qantara West about 48. On our calculation exports per worker converge at US$10-15k in Kenya, Nkok and Kigali, which turns an export target into a workforce and a housing requirement.

4 **A single policy decision can make or break a zone within a year.**
After Ethiopia lost US trade preferences on 1 January 2022, 18 firms left its parks and more than 11,400 jobs went; exports reached US$115m in FY2023/24 against a US$250m target. Gabon's 2010 ban on raw-log exports built Nkok into a 1,126 ha zone exporting about US$265m a year.

5 **Zones became cities where an existing city did the housing.**
Chrafate, the new town planned for the Tanger Med workforce, had delivered about 420 of 30,000 homes by October 2025, while the commune of Tangier counted 1,275,428 residents in 2024, more than eight times the 150,000 Chrafate was planned for. Diamniadio, Senegal's new city, is planned for 350,000 residents.

WHAT IT MEANS

Governments and investment agencies should publish customs exports, direct jobs and developed hectares by zone, and judge zones on jobs and exports per hectare.

Zone developers should sell serviced supplier land and fund commuter links into the existing city before building a new town.

Manufacturers and lenders should price the policy behind the export case, whether a foreign preference or a domestic ban, as the first risk in the model.

31
zones and zone programmes in the Heirstone Export City Benchmark, in 14 countries

4
kinds of export city, each with its own risk: metro platforms, preference enclaves, feedstock zones and platforms in waiting

CHAPTER 1



01

Where the money went

Tanger Med is counted in containers. On the group's own split, its industrial platform has drawn more than three times the investment of its port complex, and the zones decide what Morocco exports.

Tanger Med opened on the Strait of Gibraltar in 2007. In 2025 its four container terminals handled 11,106,164 TEU, up 8.4% on the year, alongside 161 million tonnes of cargo, 535,203 TIR trucks and 3.2 million passengers. The group describes it as the largest port in Africa and the Mediterranean.

Tanger Med Group's 2024 key figures put cumulative investment in the complex at US$13.56bn, of which US$5.25bn public and US$8.31bn private. The same sheet lists US$1.9bn for the port complex and US$6.39bn for the industrial platform, 3.4 dollars in the zones for every dollar at the quay. Those two lines sum to about the private total, and the sheet does not say how the public money divides; the more of it that went into port works, the narrower the gap.

The zones cover 3,000 ha and host 1,500 companies and 145,000 jobs. They generated MAD 188bn of business volume in 2025, about US$20.1bn at the year's average rate of MAD 9.35 per US dollar. This chapter follows that money from the quay to the platform.

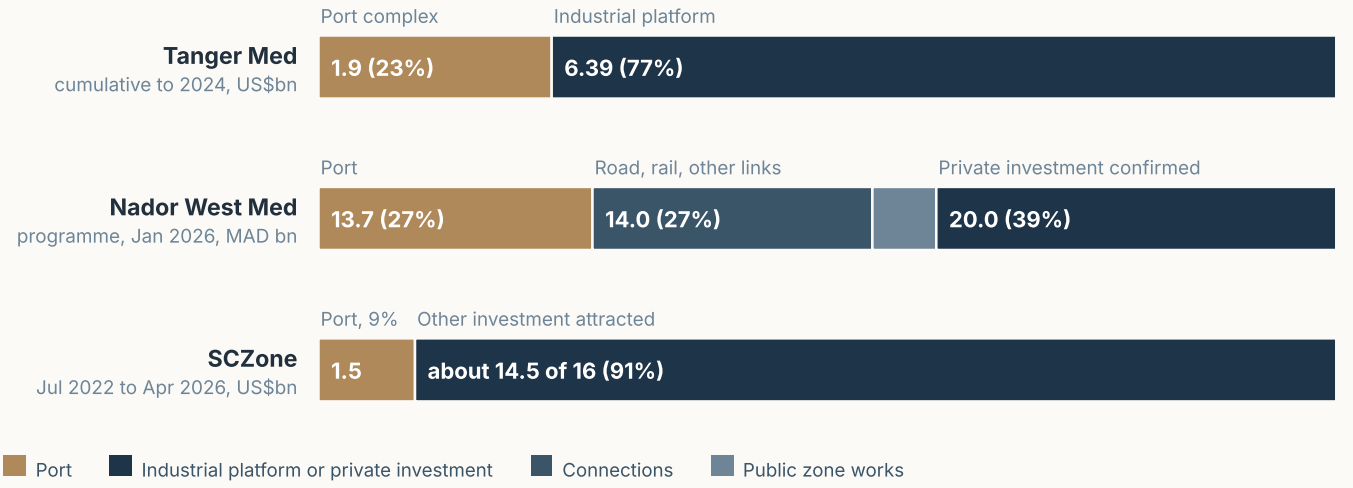
THE CAPITAL SPLIT

Three port-zone complexes, one pattern: the port is the smaller line in the budget

EXHIBIT 1

On the published splits, the port takes between a tenth and just over a quarter of the capital at three complexes

Investment by component, with share of the row total; Tanger Med cumulative to 2024; Nador West Med programme as published in January 2026; SCZone investment reported for July 2022 to April 2026



Source: Tanger Med Group, Key figures 2024 (USD), September 2025; Le Matin and Le360 quoting Nador West Med SA, 29 January 2026; Spill News citing the SCZone chairman, 5 May 2026. **Heirstone analysis.** Tanger Med's two items sum to US$8.29bn, close to the US$8.31bn private total; the sheet does not state whether they include any of the US$5.25bn of public investment. Had all of it gone to the port, the port's share would be about half. SCZone port projects (US$1.516bn in executed contracts) are shown within the US$16bn total the chairman cited; the source does not say whether that total includes them, and the port share is about 9% either way.

At Tanger Med the industrial platform's US$6.39bn equals about US$2.1m for each of the zones' 3,000 gross hectares, and about US$49,000 for each of the 130,000 jobs reported for 2024. In 2024 the zones generated US$17.22bn of business volume, about 2.7 times the cumulative investment in the platform. Private capital outweighed public by 1.6 to 1 across the complex.

Nador West Med starts from a different mix. Of MAD 51bn of public and private investment, MAD 13.7bn is for the port (about US$1.5bn at MAD 9.35 per US dollar) and MAD 14bn for road, rail and other connections. The public phase-1 industrial zones account for MAD 3.2bn, and MAD 20bn of private investment has been confirmed. The first container terminal, with a 1,520 m quay and 3.5m TEU of capacity, is due at the end of 2026.

In the Suez Canal Economic Zone the gap is wider. The zone's chairman put port projects contracted between July 2022 and April 2026 at US$1.516bn, within about US$16bn of investment he said the zone had attracted over that period, including a record US$7.1bn in FY2025/26.

For a lender or a zone developer this moves the diligence inland. A port concession has an operator and a tariff that lenders have priced many times before. The platform carries tenant, land and policy risk, and at Tanger Med it took 77% of the capital the sheet allocates by component.

US$2.1m

cumulative industrial-platform investment per gross hectare at Tanger Med, to 2024

2.7x

zone business volume in 2024 relative to cumulative platform investment

MAD 20bn

private investment confirmed at Nador West Med before its first terminal opens

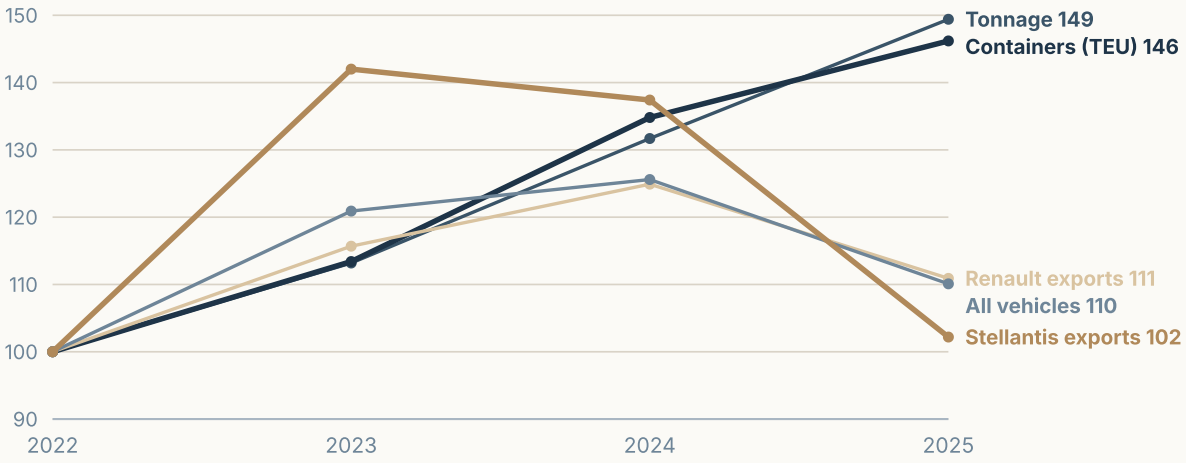
CONTAINERS AND CARS

In 2025 containers and cars moved in opposite directions at Tanger Med

EXHIBIT 2

Containers kept rising in 2025 while vehicle exports fell back towards their 2022 level

Tanger Med port traffic, index 2022 = 100



Source: Tanger Med Port Authority, port activity reports for 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025. Index: **Heirstone analysis.** 2025 values: 11,106,164 TEU; 161 Mt; 526,862 vehicles, of which 327,569 Renault and 126,874 Stellantis export units.

The port authority attributes 2025's container growth notably to the commissioning of the TC4 extension operated by APM Terminals. The vehicle terminals show the export base more directly. They handled 526,862 vehicles in 2025, 12% fewer than in 2024. Renault exports through the port fell from 368,843 to 327,569 units, or 11%, and Stellantis exports from 170,519 to 126,874, or 26%. These two makers accounted for 86% of all vehicles the port handled in 2025.

The sources we reviewed give no current transshipment share, so the 11.1m TEU cannot be split between boxes that serve Moroccan factories and boxes changing ships. The vehicle count can be read directly, and in 2025 it fell while the container count set a record.

The link between the zones and the port runs by road. Trucks through Tanger Med rose 3.6% in 2025, to 535,203, and in November 2024 the IFC lent up to EUR 197m, with a further EUR 203m commercial tranche backed by a MIGA guarantee, to lift the port's truck capacity above one million units a year from 477,000 in 2023.

East Port Said is at an earlier point in the same sequence, with the port ahead of the zone. SCZone's chairman cites 5.6m TEU there in 2026, up from 2.4m in 2024, and in November 2025 APM Terminals opened a US$500m expansion of the Suez Canal Container Terminal, taking its capacity to 7m TEU. The industrial zone beside the port counted seven projects, US$367m of investment and about 2,000 direct jobs in June 2026. Tanger Med's port opened in 2007 and its Renault anchor followed in 2012.

86%

of vehicles handled at Tanger Med in 2025 were Renault or Stellantis exports

-26%

Stellantis exports through Tanger Med in 2025, to 126,874 units

EUR 400m

IFC loan and MIGA-backed commercial tranche to lift Tanger Med's truck capacity above one million units a year (2024)

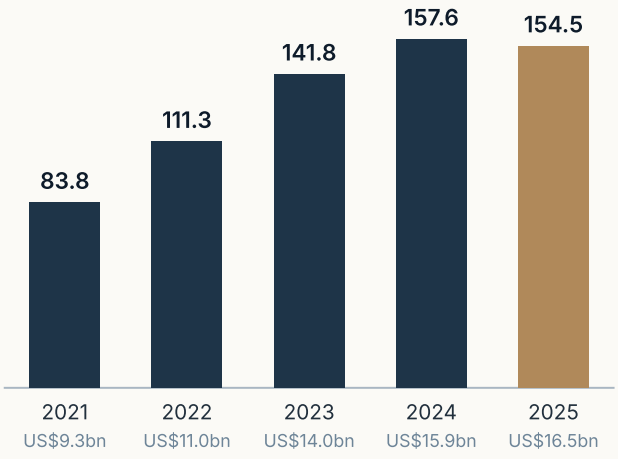
THE EXPORT BASE

A 2% fall in dirhams was a 4% rise in dollars, and three sectors carry the base

EXHIBIT 3

Automotive exports fell 2% in dirhams in 2025 and rose about 4% in US dollars

Morocco automotive exports, MAD bn as first published; US$ at World Bank annual average rates below



Source: Office des Changes, as reported by Hespress, Le360, TelQuel and Médias24 (2022 to 2026); World Bank WDI, official exchange rate (MAD 8.99 per US$ in 2021, 10.16, 10.13, 9.94 and 9.35 in 2025). Office des Changes revises earlier years. US$ conversion: **Heirstone analysis.**

Morocco's automotive exports reached MAD 154.49bn in 2025, down 2% on 2024, with vehicle assembly down 13.6%. The dirham strengthened from 9.94 to 9.35 per US dollar between the two years, so in dollars the same exports rose about 4%, from US$15.9bn to US$16.5bn. Components held up better than finished cars: at the end of November, wiring and interiors were each up 6.1% and vehicle construction down 15%.

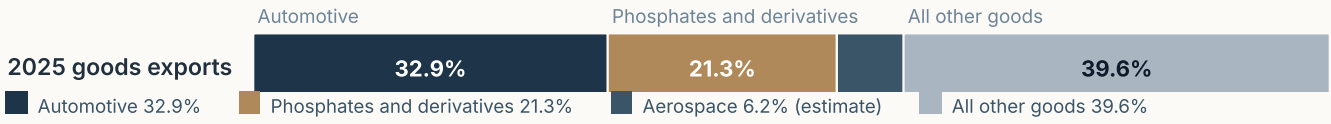
Capacity is the next lever, ahead of land. Stellantis raised Kenitra's capacity to 535,000 units a year in July 2025; the data firm Inovev estimates the plant produced about 190,000 vehicles in 2024, around 36% of the new figure. Renault Group Maroc produced 394,474 vehicles in 2025, below its 2024 record of 413,614, and exported 327,552 of them to 63 countries.

The supplier tier is where the growth in local value sits. Renault Group Maroc reported a 65.5% local integration rate and EUR 2.39bn of local sourcing for 2024 from about 250 suppliers; its tier-1 suppliers rose from 26 in 2016 to 88 in 2023. Stellantis targets 75% integration at Kenitra and over EUR 6bn of Moroccan purchases by 2030, against about EUR 700m today.

EXHIBIT 4

Three sectors made up about 60% of Morocco's goods exports in 2025

Share of goods exports by value, 2025; total MAD 469.08bn (about US$50.2bn at MAD 9.35 per US$)



Source: Office des Changes, as reported by Médias24 (31 January 2026), FNH and Hespress (February 2026). Aerospace for 2025 is a **Heirstone estimate**: MAD 26.45bn in 2024 plus the reported growth of about 10%. Goods imports were MAD 822.22bn, a coverage rate of 57%.

The concentration matters for the cities that host the plants. Tanger Med Zones' automotive business volume of MAD 125bn in 2025 is equivalent to about 81% of national automotive exports, although business volume is turnover and includes domestic sales, so the two are not like for like. Most of Morocco's automotive export base sits in the Tanger Med zones and at Kenitra, and both export vehicles through Tanger Med.

CHAPTER 2

02

Hectares, jobs and exports

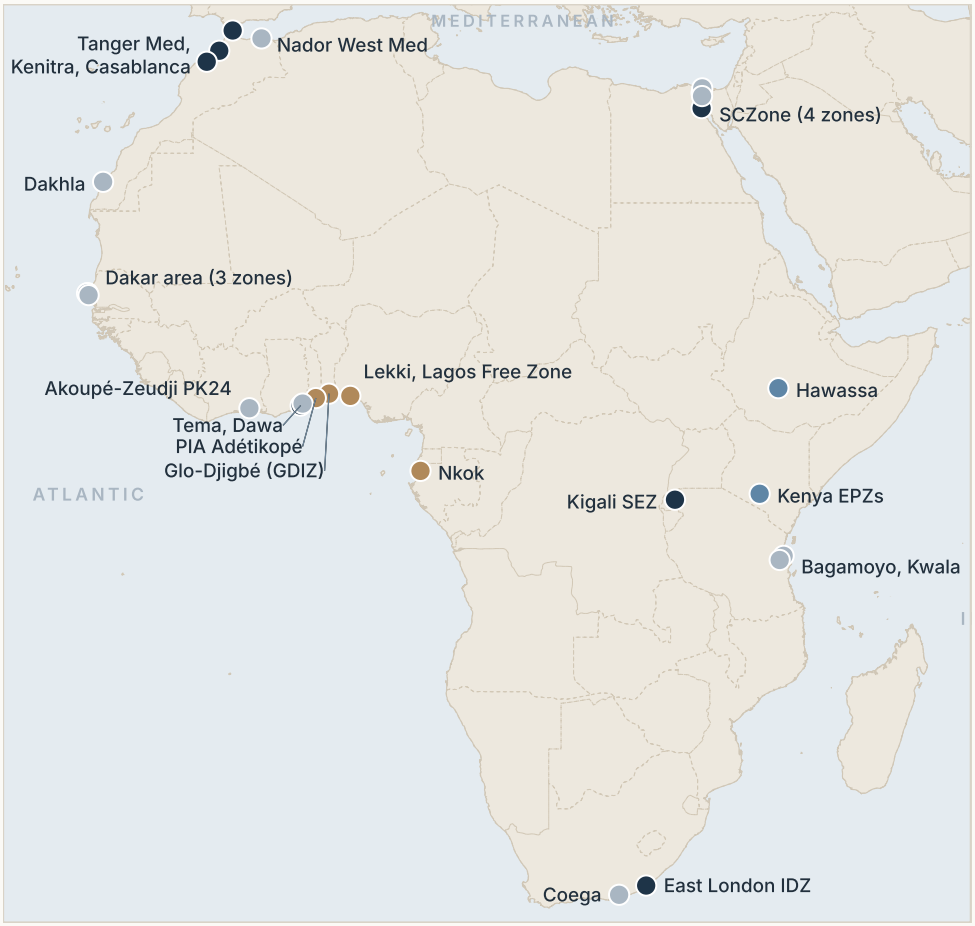
The Heirstone Export City Benchmark brings together public data on 31 zones and zone programmes in 14 African countries. For each we record area, investment, firms, jobs and exports or the nearest published proxy, and compute three ratios that zone authorities rarely publish: jobs per hectare, exports per hectare and investment per job.

The bases differ. Some zones report direct jobs, others direct and indirect; some publish gross area, others developed land; Tanger Med reports business volume, which is turnover, in place of customs exports. We show the basis for every figure and keep targets apart from results.

EXHIBIT 5

The benchmark runs from Tangier to the Eastern Cape

Zones in the Heirstone Export City Benchmark, coloured by type of export city (defined in chapter 5)



Source: Heirstone Export City Benchmark 2026. Positions are approximate host-town locations from OpenStreetMap, not zone boundaries. SCZone: Sokhna, Qantara West, East Port Said, East Ismailia. Dakar area: APROSI sites incl. Diamniadio, Bargny-Sendou, Ndayane. Tanger Med zones include Tetouan Park and the Renault plant.

FOUR TYPES

- Metro platform
- Preference enclave
- Feedstock zone
- Platform in waiting

North Africa contributes twelve of the 31 zones, francophone West and Central Africa seven, and anglophone, East and Southern Africa twelve. We found no comparable published zone-level figures for Algeria, Tunisia or Libya.

31

zones and zone programmes in 14 countries

10

zones that publish area, jobs and an investment figure, one of them as projections

THE BENCHMARK

The Heirstone Export City Benchmark

Metro platform · Preference enclave · Feedstock zone · Platform in waiting

EXHIBIT 6

Thirty-one zones in fourteen countries, with the ratios their authorities do not publish

Latest published figures; shaded columns are **Heirstone analysis**. US$ at 2025 averages (MAD 9.35, CFA 580 and KSh 129 per US$; US$1.13 per euro; ZAR 16.4), except Kenitra 2019 (MAD 9.62). Kenitra: 345 ha is the original area (CDG; Médias24 reports later extensions), 600 ha the area cited by the trade press in 2025. Akoupé-Zeudji ratios use the 284 ha allocated.

ZONE	COUNTRY	YEAR	AREA, HA	INVEST-MENT, US$M	FIRMS	JOBS	EXPORTS, US$M A YEAR	JOBS PER HA	EXPORTS PER HA, US$K	INVEST. PER JOB, US$K
NORTH AFRICA										
Tanger Med Zones (all)	Morocco	2024-25	3,000	6,390[a]	1,500	145,000	20,100[b]	48	6,700[b]	49
Renault plant, Melloussa	Morocco	2025	300	n/p	1	6,244	n/p	21	n/p	n/p
Tanger Automotive City	Morocco	current	800	4,000[g]	150[g]	40,000[g]	n/p	50[g]	n/p	n/p
Atlantic Free Zone, Kenitra	Morocco	2019	345-600	1,870[a]	25	25,300	n/p	42-73	n/p	74
Midparc, Casablanca	Morocco	2025	125	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p
Tetouan Park	Morocco	current	156	145	126[p]	4,000	n/a	26	n/a	36
Nador West Med, phase 1	Morocco	2026	700	2,140[a]	n/p	50,000[c]	n/a	71[c]	n/a	n/a
Dakhla Atlantique	Morocco	2025	1,650	1,330[h]	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
SCZone Sokhna	Egypt	2026	n/p	33,100[a]	547[p]	133,000	n/p	n/p	n/p	249
SCZone Qantara West	Egypt	2026	n/p	1,500[a]	52[p]	72,000	n/p	n/p	n/p	21
SCZone East Port Said	Egypt	2026	n/p	367[a]	7[p]	2,000	n/p	n/p	n/p	184
SCZone East Ismailia	Egypt	2026	n/p	59[a]	4[p]	900	n/p	n/p	n/p	66
EAST AFRICA										
Hawassa Industrial Park	Ethiopia	2016-22	130	250[h]	21	35,000[k]	20	269	154	7
IPDC parks (13)	Ethiopia	2025/26	n/p	n/p	200[e]	100,000[e]	267	n/a	n/a	n/a
EPZ programme (101 zones)	Kenya	2024	n/p	1,154[a]	174	72,034	826	n/a	n/a	16
Kigali SEZ	Rwanda	2025	n/p	n/p	230	20,000	290	n/p	n/p	n/p
Bagamoyo port-SEZ (stalled)	Tanzania	2013	n/p	10,000[c]	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
Kwala Industrial Park	Tanzania	2026	n/p	n/p	200[c]	50,000[c]	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
WEST AND CENTRAL AFRICA										
GSEZ Nkok	Gabon	2023	1,126	1,600[a]	144	25,000[d]	265	22	235	64
Glo-Djigbé (GDIZ)	Benin	2023-26	400	1,469[a]	12[o]	25,000	n/p	62	n/p	59
PIA Adétikopé	Togo	2025	400	603[a]	12[o]	6,580	n/p	16	n/p	92
Akoupé-Zeudji PK24	Côte d'Ivoire	2026	1,000	989[c]	67[o]	12,887[c]	n/p	45[c]	n/p	77[c]
APROSI sites incl. P2ID	Senegal	current	2,000[f]	342[a]	71	11,817	390[b]	6	n/p	29
Bargny-Sendou port zone	Senegal	2026	480	n/p	n/p	2,600[c]	n/a	5[c]	n/a	n/a
Ndayane port and zone	Senegal	2026	n/p	1,200[h]	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
Lekki FTZ (Dangote)	Nigeria	2024-26	15,500[f]	20,000[h]	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p
Lagos Free Zone	Nigeria	2026	n/p	2,700[a]	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p
Tema EPZ	Ghana	current	480	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p	n/p
Dawa Industrial Zone	Ghana	2021	8,903[f]	n/p	6	80,000[c]	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
SOUTHERN AFRICA										
Coega SEZ	South Africa	2021/22	11,500	n/p	55	19,199	n/p	2	n/p	n/p
East London IDZ	South Africa	2024	400	488[a]	40	5,000	n/p	13	n/p	98

a cumulative, committed or confirmed investment as published; **b** business volume or turnover, not customs exports; **c** target or projection; **d** direct and indirect jobs; **e** authority claim; **f** master-plan, landholding or reserve area; **g** ecosystem-wide figure including firms outside the zone; **h** construction cost; **k** peak employment, year not published; **o** firms operating; **p** projects. n/p not published; n/a not applicable yet. Sokhna includes Red Sea Petrochemicals (US$7.5bn) and XinFeng steel (US$1.65bn).

Source: Heirstone Export City Benchmark 2026, compiled from Tanger Med Group and Tanger Med Zones; CDG and Médias24 (2019); IGAPE (2025); Le360 and Le Matin (2026); Médias24 (2025); Egypt Today citing the Cabinet Media Center (June 2026); Sudan Tribune, Cepheus Capital and Texfash (Hawassa); SCZone (Sokhna); ThisDay and Czech embassy in Abuja (Lekki); SAOGA (Coega); The Citizen (Bagamoyo); Kana TV citing IPDC (2026); IPDC; EPZA Kenya (March 2024); The New Times (2026); ARISE IIP; US ITA (2024); Government of Benin (2023); Bird Story Agency (2026); Togonews (2026); Team France Export (2026); APROSI; Le Soleil (2026); Maritimafrica (2022, 2026); Lagos Free Zone; GFZA; Ghana News Agency (2021); SAnews (2022); East London IDZ (2024); TISEZA.

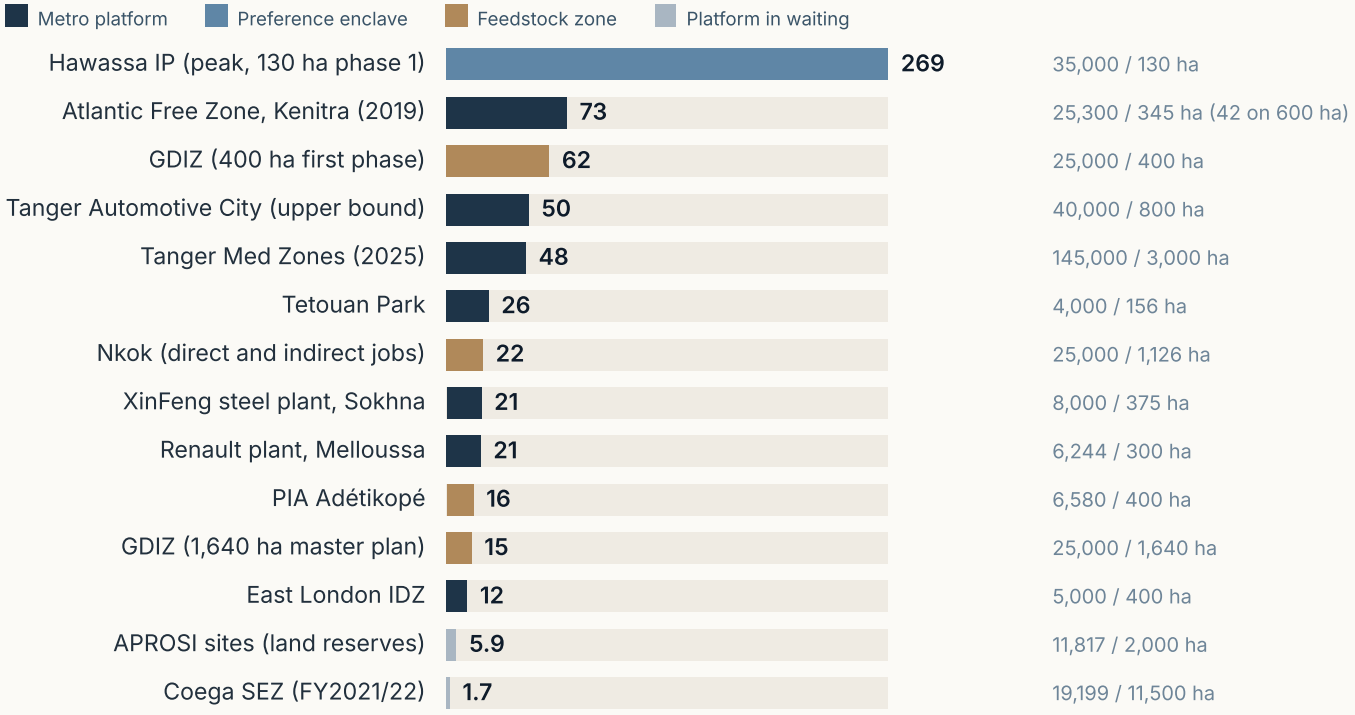
DENSITY

Achieved density varies more than a hundredfold across the benchmark

EXHIBIT 7

Supplier parks and garment sheds pack in the most jobs; large land banks the fewest

Jobs per gross hectare, latest published year; inputs shown on the right



Source: Heirstone Export City Benchmark 2026. **Heirstone analysis** of figures from Tanger Med Zones; CDG and Médias24 (2019); Sudan Tribune (2016) and Texfash (2022) for Hawassa; SCZone (2025) for XinFeng, 3.75m sq m; Government of Benin and Bird Story Agency; ARISE IIP; Togonews; East London IDZ; APROSI; SAnews. Tanger Automotive City jobs cover its whole ecosystem, including firms outside the zone.

Zones are announced in hectares. Across the benchmark, achieved density runs from about 2 jobs per gross hectare at Coega to about 269 at Hawassa's peak, where garment sheds put 35,000 workers on a 130 ha first phase.

Within Morocco's automotive system the pattern is consistent. The Renault plant at Melloussa employs 6,244 people on 300 ha, about 21 per hectare, and produced roughly 1,000 vehicles per hectare in 2025. Supplier parks are denser: the Atlantic Free Zone at Kenitra had 25,300 direct jobs in 2019, about 73 per hectare on its original 345 ha and 42 on the 600 ha cited in 2025 trade press. Médias24 reported three extensions by 2019, so the lower figure is the safer one. Most of the employment in an automotive export city sits in the supplier tier. XinFeng's steel plant at Sokhna, with 8,000 jobs on 375 ha, has the same density as the Renault plant.

The area basis changes the answer, as Kenitra shows. GDIZ has 62 jobs per hectare on its 400 ha first phase and 15 on its 1,640 ha master plan. Targets deserve the same test: Nador West Med's 50,000 direct jobs by 2035 on a 700 ha first phase imply 71 per hectare, above the 48 that Tanger Med Zones has reached 26 years after Tanger Free Zone opened.

~1,000

vehicles per hectare produced at the Renault plant in Melloussa in 2025 (299,395 on 300 ha)

42 to 73

jobs per hectare at Kenitra's Atlantic Free Zone, depending on whether 345 ha or 600 ha is used

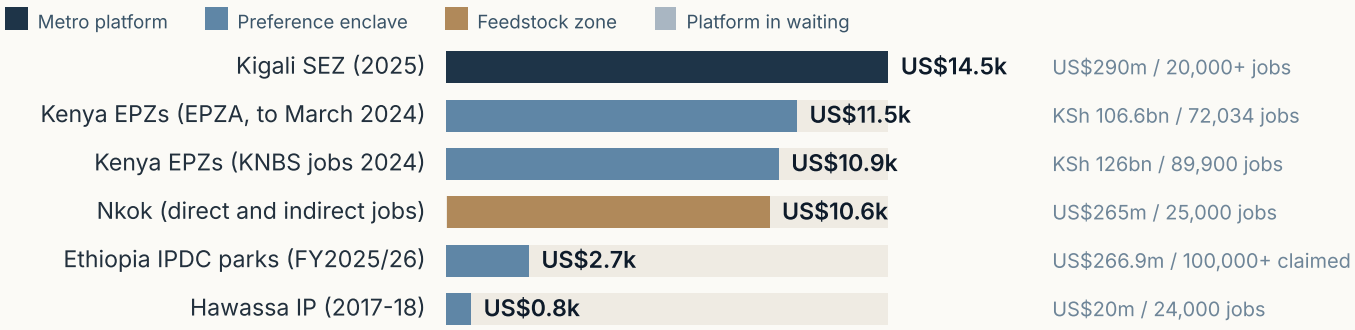
EXPORTS AND CAPITAL PER JOB

Exports per worker cluster at US$10-15k. Jobs per dollar depend on what a zone was built for.

EXHIBIT 8

Three different zones export US$10-15k per worker; Ethiopia's parks a quarter of that or less

Exports per job, US$ thousand a year; inputs on the right

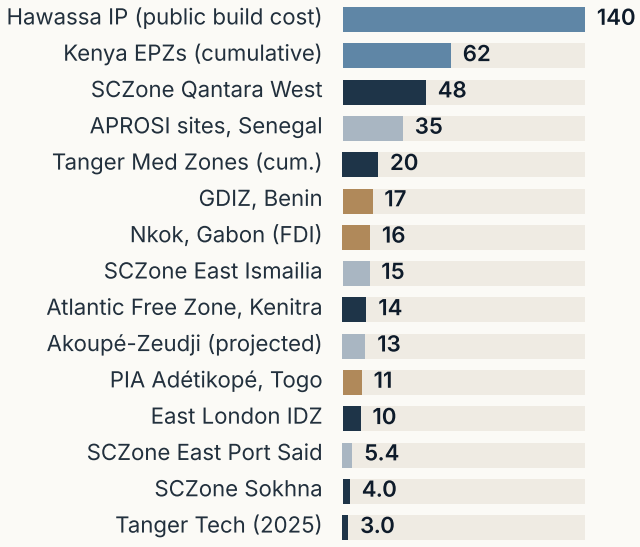


Source: Heirstone analysis of The New Times citing RDB (2026); EPZA Kenya (March 2024); The Star and KNBS Economic Survey 2025; ARISE IIP; Kana TV citing IPDC (2026); IPDC website; Cepheus Capital industrial parks data pack citing EIC (2019) for Hawassa. KSh at 129 per US$ (mid-2025). Jobs and exports come from different releases in some rows.

EXHIBIT 9

Qantara West has the most jobs per dollar of the metro platforms we could measure

Direct jobs per US$1m invested; investment as published (cumulative, committed or build cost)



Source: Heirstone analysis of the sources in Exhibit 6, plus Morocco World News citing Tanger Med Group (Tanger Tech: MAD 12.22bn, 3,882 jobs). Bases differ: Hawassa uses public build cost, Nkok total FDI with direct and indirect jobs.

Exports per worker converge in three zones that have little else in common: Kigali's inland special economic zone, Kenya's apparel-heavy EPZs and Gabon's wood-processing zone at Nkok all land between about US$10,000 and US$15,000 a year. Ethiopia's parks, measured against the jobs IPDC claims, export about US$2,700 per job.

That convergence gives a sizing rule. Exports per hectare equal jobs per hectare multiplied by exports per worker: Nkok's 22 jobs and US$10.6k per job give its US$235k per hectare. Read the other way, for a zone that performs like these three, each US$100m of export target implies 6,700 to 10,000 jobs and, at Tanger Med Zones' 48 jobs per hectare, 140 to 210 ha of zone.

Jobs per dollar separates zones built for employment from zones built for capital, and SCZone has both. Sokhna has attracted US$33.1bn across 547 projects and more than 133,000 direct jobs, about 4 per US$1m. Qantara West, with US$1.5bn and about 72,000 jobs, has 48. For housing, transport and services, Sokhna sets the larger requirement in absolute terms and Qantara West the larger per dollar. Tangier shows the same split: the Tanger Med Zones projects confirmed in 2025 carry about 22 jobs per US$1m, the Tanger Tech projects about 3.

CHAPTER 3

03

One decision, one year

The policy that creates a zone's export case can change faster than any building cycle. Zone feasibility studies rarely model it.

Ethiopia's industrial parks were designed around duty-free access to the US market under the African Growth and Opportunity Act. In 2021 the United States announced that Ethiopia's eligibility would end, and on 1 January 2022 it did. By September 2022 IPDC reported about 5,000 layoffs. In all, 18 foreign companies left the parks, more than 11,400 workers lost their jobs and the parks lost about US$45m of revenue, according to a National Bank of Ethiopia economist and IPDC.

Gabon shows the same speed in the other direction. It decided in 2009 to ban raw-log exports, effective in 2010, and opened the Nkok special economic zone the same year. Nkok now covers 1,126 ha and hosts 144 companies, 84 of them in wood processing, and exports about US$265m of products a year, according to its developer ARISE IIP.

One decision was taken abroad, the other at home. Zone business plans model land, utilities and tax holidays in detail and tend to treat the policy behind the export case as fixed. This chapter measures what happened when it moved.

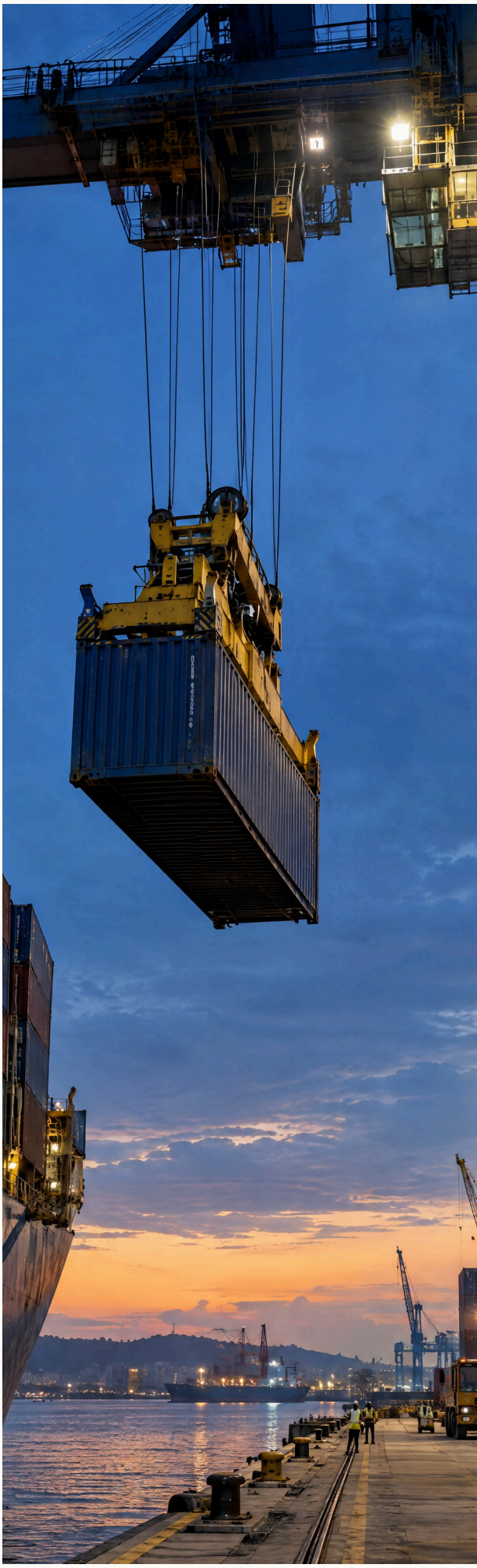
> *Ethiopia's parks exported 46% of their target in the second fiscal year after US preferences ended. Nkok's container exports rose 160% in four years under a ban.*

18

foreign firms left Ethiopia's parks after January 2022

US$265m

exports a year from Nkok, built on Gabon's 2010 log ban



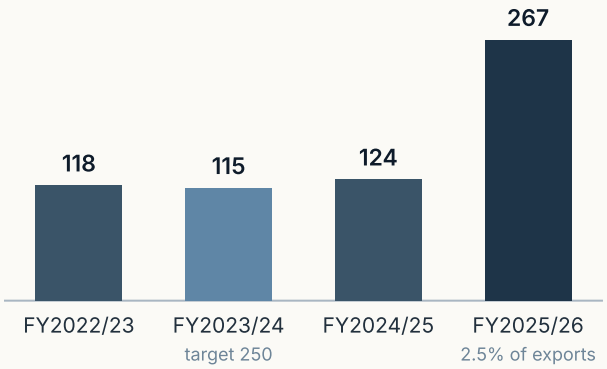
TRADE PREFERENCES

Preference zones grew on access to the US market and stalled when it was withdrawn or in doubt

EXHIBIT 10

Ethiopia's park exports reached 46% of target in FY2023/24 and doubled two years later

Exports from Ethiopia's industrial parks, US$m, fiscal years ending in July

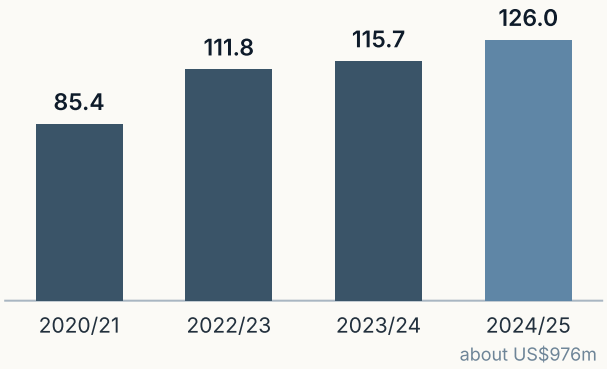


Source: Capital Ethiopia citing the Ethiopian Investment Commission (22 July 2024); Kana TV citing the IPDC annual review (28 July 2026). Earlier park export figures conflict between sources and are not shown.

EXHIBIT 11

Kenya's EPZ exports rose by about half in four years

Exports from Kenya's export processing zones, KSh bn, fiscal years to June (2021/22 not published in the source)



Source: The Star (18 December 2025). Nominal shillings; only the latest year is converted, at KSh 129 per US$ (mid-2025), because the exchange rate moved materially over the period.

The FY2023/24 result, US$115.2m against a US$250m target, came with a further detail from the Ethiopian Investment Commission: only four parks generated export revenue, and Bole Lemi and Hawassa provided half of it. In the first nine months of FY2024/25 the parks exported US$83m against a US$127m target, according to IPDC, and the head of the Hawassa park's investors' association put its lines at 30 to 40% of capacity.

Recovery followed. IPDC reported exports of US$266.9m in FY2025/26, more than double the US$124m of the year before. That is 2.5% of Ethiopia's US$10.7bn of exports, and below the roughly US$360m a year implied by the US$30m a month of apparel and footwear the parks exported at the 2019 peak, according to a study by a National Bank of Ethiopia economist reported by Addis Fortune.

Kenya is the larger case. Its EPZs exported KSh 126bn in 2024/25, about US$976m. In 2024 they employed 89,900 people directly, and the 40 AGOA apparel enterprises accounted for 66,800 of them, about three-quarters. Uncertainty showed in hiring first: EPZ firms added 12,069 workers in the year to June 2025, against a target of 8,000, then lost 5,337 planned job openings in FY2025/26 as expansions were delayed. AGOA expired on 30 September 2025; according to KPMG, it was reauthorised on 3 February 2026 until 31 December 2026, with retroactive effect.

74%

of Kenya's direct EPZ jobs were in AGOA apparel enterprises in 2024 (66,800 of 89,900)

2.5%

share of Ethiopia's national exports shipped from its industrial parks in FY2025/26

30-40%

capacity use on Hawassa's lines in 2025, according to the park's investors' association

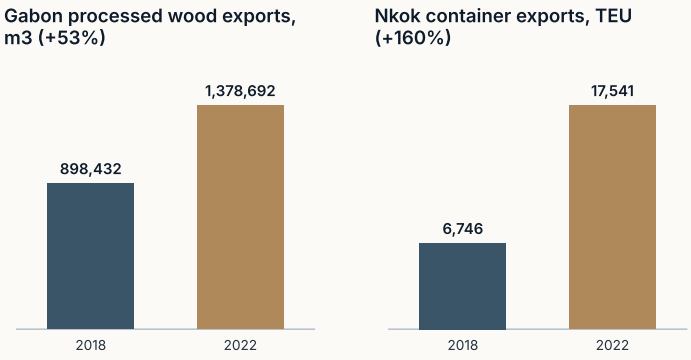
FEEDSTOCK AND BANS

A raw-material ban builds a zone when the material cannot easily leave by land

EXHIBIT 12

Gabon's processed wood exports rose 53% and Nkok's container exports 160% in four years

Before and after, 2018 and 2022



Source: US International Trade Administration, Gabon Country Commercial Guide: Wood Products (7 March 2024). ITA cites the zone at 1,350 ha; ARISE IIP gives 1,126 ha.

Gabon's ban has the clearest record. The zone processed 1,000,000 m3 of timber in 2023. The World Bank puts the wood sector at 3.2% of GDP, 6% of exports and almost 15,000 jobs in 2023, with forestry fiscal revenue of CFA 41.9bn, about US$69m at CFA 605 per US dollar, almost four times the 2016 level.

Benin is testing the mechanism on two crops. GDIZ, 45 km north of Cotonou, has fibre-processing capacity equal to about 12.7% of the country's cotton fibre output and employed 16,000 people in textiles by August 2026. Benin banned raw cashew exports in April 2024; according to a tree-nut market analyst quoted by Ecofin Agency in June 2026, slightly less than 30% of the harvest was processed in the country and nearly 70% went to Togo or Nigeria.

In our reading, the difference lies in how the raw material leaves. Logs need heavy transport and a port the state controls; nuts cross land borders by the truckload. Togo's PIA, 15 km north of Lomé, processes local cotton, soy, shea and cashew, and shipped more than 210,000 T-shirts to the United States in 2025. Garments sold to US retailers from GDIZ and PIA mean these zones also carry part of the preference risk on the previous page.

EXHIBIT 13

Six decisions that moved African export zones within a year or two

Heirstone ledger of policy, market and investment decisions and their published effects

DECISION	WHO AND WHEN	WHAT FOLLOWED
Raw-log export ban	Gabon; decided 2009, in force 2010	Nkok grew to 1,126 ha and 144 firms; processed wood exports +53% (2018-22); forestry fiscal revenue CFA 41.9bn in 2023, almost four times 2016
AGOA eligibility ended	United States for Ethiopia; 1 January 2022	18 firms and 11,400+ jobs left the parks; FY2023/24 exports 46% of target; FY2025/26 exports US$266.9m
Fertiliser price cycle	World market; 2022 to 2023	Morocco's phosphate and derivative exports fell from MAD 115.5bn to 76.1bn (-34%) in a year, then recovered to 99.8bn in 2025
Raw cashew export ban	Benin; April 2024	Slightly under 30% of a 170,000-180,000 t harvest processed at home; nearly 70% went to Togo or Nigeria, according to a market analyst (June 2026)
No phase-2 investment decision	GTA partners, Senegal and Mauritania; as of July 2025	Domestic gas for power and industry not yet committed while port-side industrial land proceeds (Bargny-Sendou end-2026, Ndayane 2028)
AGOA lapse and renewal	United States; 30 September 2025 to 3 February 2026	Kenya's EPZs lost 5,337 planned job openings in FY2025/26; programme renewed to 31 December 2026, according to KPMG

Source: Heirstone compilation from World Bank, Gabon Economic Update 2024; US ITA (2024); Addis Fortune (May 2025) and Capital Ethiopia (July 2024); Kana TV (July 2026); Office des Changes via Le360 and Hespress; Ecofin Agency (11 June 2026); S&P Global Commodity Insights (14 July 2025); Le Soleil (April 2026); Maritimafrica (July 2026); Business Daily Africa (3 September 2026); Al Jazeera (2022); Trade Preferences Extension Act of 2015; KPMG (February 2026).

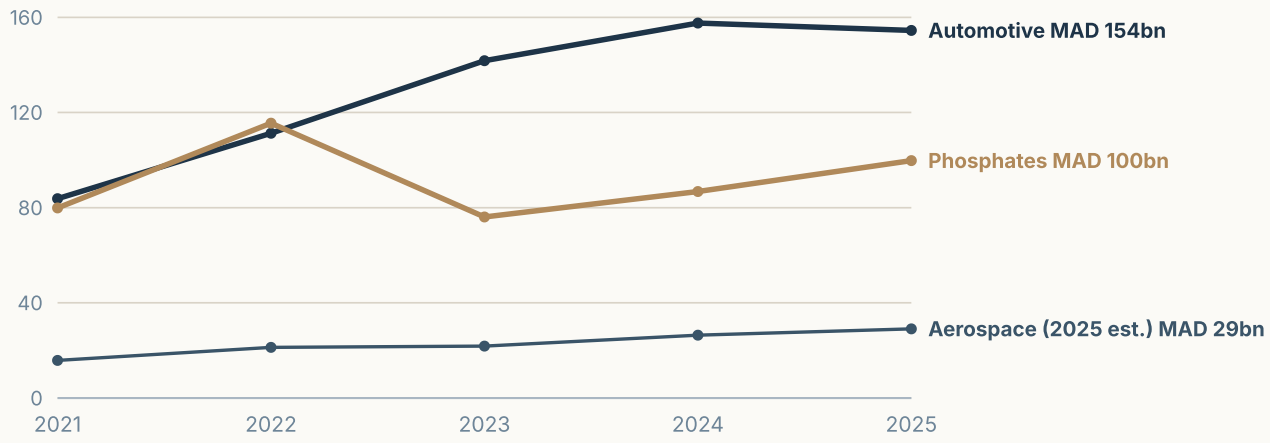
PRICE AND VOLUME

Resource-processing cities earn on price; assembly cities earn on volume

EXHIBIT 14

Morocco's phosphate earnings fell by a third in 2023 while automotive exports kept rising

Exports by sector, MAD bn as first published; phosphates include derivatives (acid and fertilisers)



Source: Office des Changes, as reported by Hespress, Le360, TelQuel, FNH and Médias24 (2022 to 2026). Aerospace for 2021, 2022 and 2025 is back- or forward-calculated from published growth rates (**Heirstone estimate**).

The export cities built on a raw material behave differently from those built on assembly. Morocco's phosphate and derivative exports rose 57.1% in 2021, to MAD 79.89bn, while fertiliser prices rose 71.4% and volumes fell 7.1%. They rose again to MAD 115.5bn in 2022, fell 34% to MAD 76.1bn in 2023 and recovered to MAD 99.8bn in 2025. Automotive exports fell in one year of the five, by 2%.

OCP kept adding processing capacity at Jorf Lasfar in 2025: a 500,000 t a year TSP line from July and a 1,500 t a day phosphoric acid unit from March. Group revenue reached MAD 113.9bn in 2025, up 17%. In the first half of 2025, South America took 26% of sales, Europe 21%, India 19% and Africa 18%.

Lagos's Lekki zone holds the largest single project in the benchmark. The Dangote refinery, of 650,000 barrels a day, cost about US$20bn and began producing petrol in 2024, according to ThisDay. Dangote Fertiliser has 3 Mtpa of urea capacity; in June 2026 the group announced a US$7bn programme to reach 9 Mtpa in Nigeria and targets more than US$4bn of exports a year. Nigeria's urea exports were NGN 856bn in the first quarter of 2025, about US$560m, against NGN 240.6bn a year earlier, a rise inflated by the naira's devaluation.

The free trade zone around it covers about 155 km2. We found no published employment figure for either Dangote plant, so the benchmark cannot yet score Lekki on density or jobs per dollar.

-34%

Morocco's phosphate and derivative exports, 2022 to 2023

+71.4%

rise in fertiliser prices in 2021, while export volumes fell 7.1%

650,000

barrels a day of refining capacity at the Dangote refinery in the Lekki zone

CHAPTER 4

04

The town that did not come

Chrafate was planned in 2009 to house the Tanger Med workforce. The workforce went to Tangier.

420 of 30,000

homes delivered at Chrafate by October 2025, sixteen years after launch. In 2024 the commune of Tangier had 1,275,428 residents, more than eight times the population Chrafate was planned for.

Al Omrane launched Chrafate on 8 January 2009 on 770 ha, with 30,000 planned homes for 150,000 people. In 2013 it was presented as a 1,300 ha new town less than 20 km from Tangier, serving Renault and Tanger Automotive City, whose workforce could reach 30,000 to 35,000. By October 2025 Al Omrane had delivered just over 420 homes in the first phase, with about 418 under construction and more than 1,350 planned. It cited 33,000 employees in the nearby industrial zone who need housing. Social units there start at MAD 250,000, or MAD 150,000 after state housing aid, for 45 m2.

The population went to the existing cities. The 2024 census counted 1,275,428 people in the commune of Tangier and 422,757 in Tetouan, home of Tetouan Park, against 18,854 in Melloussa, the rural commune that hosts the Renault plant. Kenitra, home of the Stellantis plant, has its Atlantic Free Zone 10 km east of the city.

Tanger Med Zones' 145,000 jobs equal about one zone job for every ten residents of the Tanger-Assilah prefecture. The zones sit 39 to 63 km from the port; Tanger Free Zone lies on the edge of Tangier itself. The labour market that fills them is the metropolitan one.

Chrafate is not an outlier. Across the benchmark, the zones that became part of a city did so by plugging into one that already existed. Al Omrane's four flagship new towns, Chrafate, Tamesna, Tamansourt and Lakhyayta, were planned for 233,000 homes and 1.1 million people on 4,833 ha; the lesson of Chrafate is about sequence, and the next pages show it recurring in Senegal and Ghana.

1.4%
of Chrafate's 30,000 planned homes delivered by October 2025

8.5x
Tangier commune residents in 2024 (1,275,428) against the 150,000 Chrafate was planned for

1 in 10
Tanger Med Zones jobs per resident of the Tanger-Assilah prefecture

33,000
employees in the industrial zone near Chrafate who need housing, according to Al Omrane

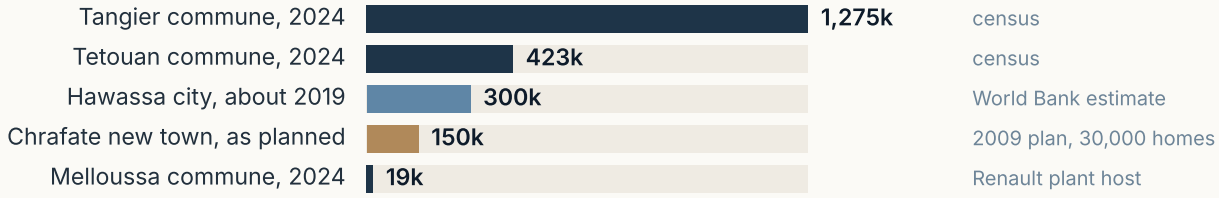
PLANS AND RESULTS

New towns and long-range job targets sit furthest from plan

EXHIBIT 15

The commune of Tangier alone is more than eight times the town planned for Chrafate

Residents, thousands: 2024 census for Moroccan communes, World Bank estimate for Hawassa, and the population planned for Chrafate

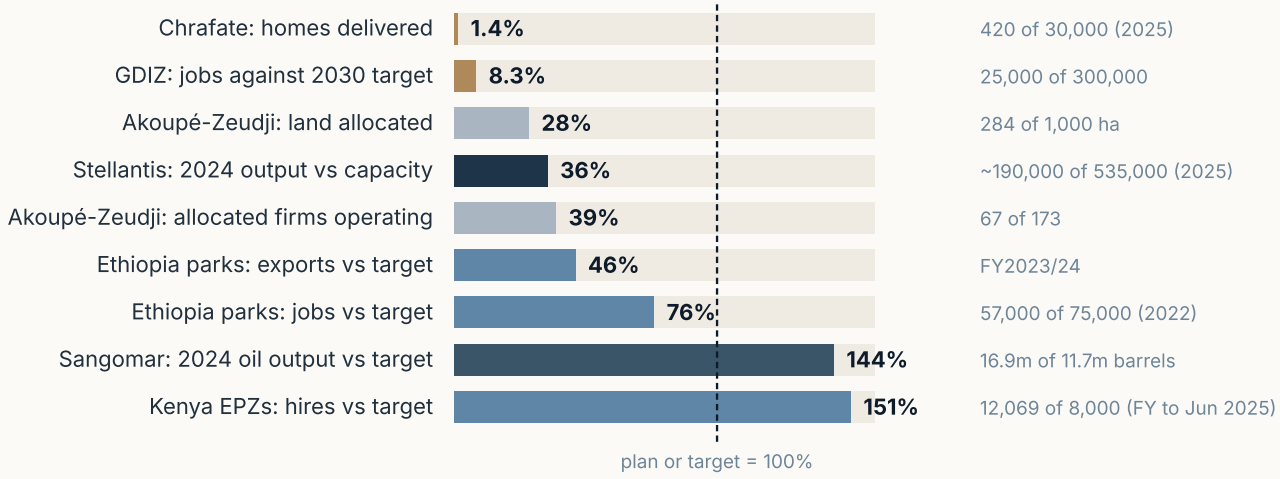


Source: HCP, RGPH 2024 legal population; World Bank, Hawassa Industrial Park Community Impact Evaluation (2019); Al Omrane (2009 plan). Ratio: **Heirstone analysis.**

EXHIBIT 16

Results range from 1.4% of Chrafate's planned homes to 151% of Kenya's hiring target

Achieved as a share of the published plan, target or capacity, latest year



Source: Heirstone analysis of Le Matin quoting Al Omrane (Oct 2025); Government of Benin (2023) and Bird Story Agency (Aug 2026); Team France Export (Feb 2026); Stellantis (Jul 2025) and Inovev via Journal de l'Automobile (Nov 2025); Capital Ethiopia (2024); The Reporter (2022); African Energy Week (Jul 2025); Business Daily Africa (Nov 2025).

Hawassa is the clearest case of a zone grafted onto an existing city. The industrial park opened in 2016 beside a city that a World Bank evaluation described in 2019 as having around 300,000 inhabitants.

Tema, in Ghana, is the older model. Its port was begun in 1954 and commissioned in 1962, according to the Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority. The free zone, of 480 ha, sits inside the port city.

Lekki is the largest planned version of the idea. Its free trade zone covers about 155 km2, with 120,000 residents planned in the first phase, according to the Czech embassy in Abuja. Its two largest anchors so far, the refinery and the fertiliser plant, are capital-heavy, and we found no published count of residents or jobs against which to measure the plan.

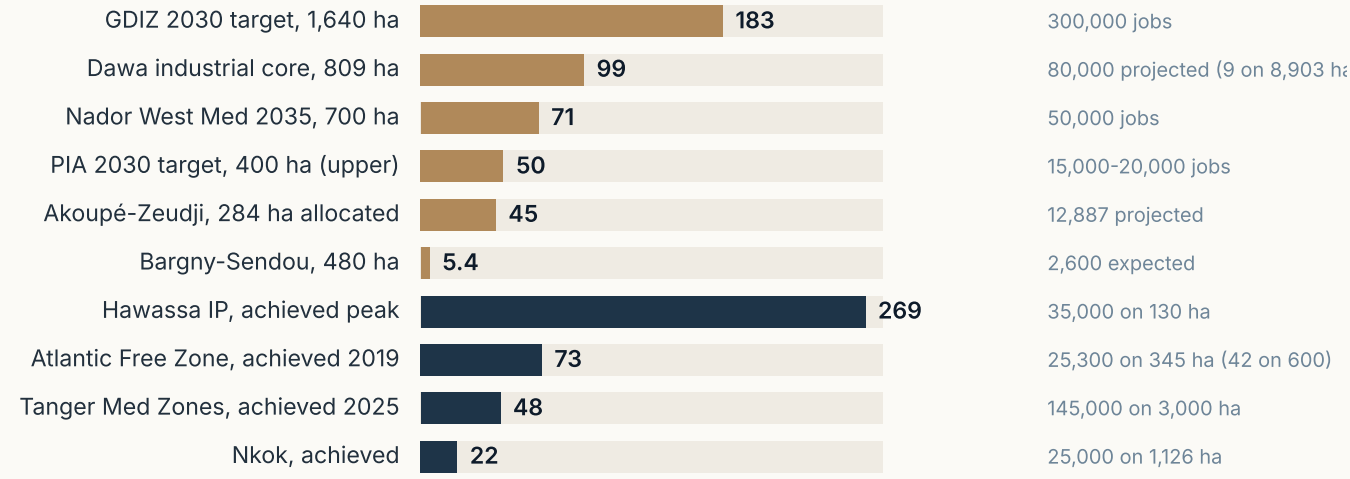
SIZING THE CITY

A zone's job target already contains its housing requirement

EXHIBIT 17

GDIZ's 2030 job target implies a density only Hawassa's garment sheds have reached

Jobs per gross hectare implied by published targets (gold) against densities achieved (navy)



Source: Heirstone analysis of Government of Benin (2023); Ghana News Agency (2021) and Dawa City Limited (2020); Le360 and Le Matin (2026); Togonews (2026); Team France Export (2026); Le Soleil (2026); and the achieved figures in Exhibit 7.

Published job targets can be tested against what comparable zones have achieved. GDIZ's target of 300,000 direct jobs by 2030, on a 1,640 ha master plan, implies 183 jobs per hectare. Only Hawassa's first phase, at its peak, reached a comparable density. At US$10-15k of exports per worker, the target would also imply US$3.0bn to US$4.5bn of exports a year from one zone; Nador West Med's 50,000 jobs would imply US$0.5bn to US$0.75bn.

Dawa, a private 22,000-acre (8,903 ha) project in Ghana, had six operating companies in April 2021 against projections of 80,000 direct and 250,000 indirect jobs. A Kiel Institute study of Tema EPZ, Dawa and Sekondi traced low occupancy to land and development issues, poor accessibility and Covid-19. In Senegal, the Diamniadio urban pole, about 30 km from central Dakar, is planned for 350,000 residents in 45,000 homes, according to its development agency.

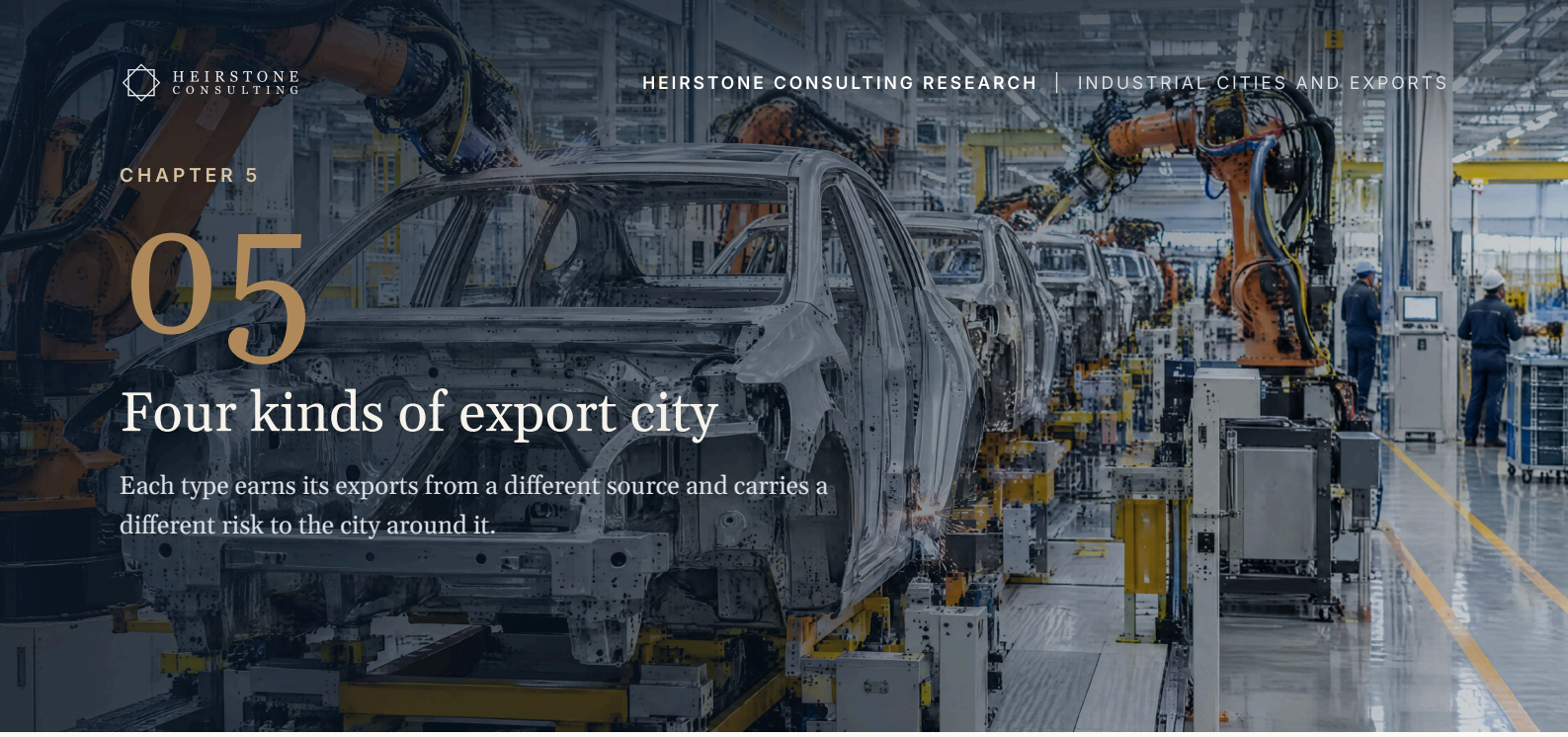
The arithmetic runs one way. A target for exports gives a workforce; the workforce gives the homes, schools, clinics and buses the zone needs within commuting range. Nador West Med's 50,000 jobs would be a third of Tanger Med Zones' workforce today. Our companion report *Factories need beds* covers how African zones house that workforce; the evidence here says the first decision is where, and the answer has usually been the nearest existing city.

183

jobs per hectare implied by GDIZ's 2030 target across its 1,640 ha master plan

6

operating companies at Dawa in 2021, on 8,903 ha planned for 80,000 direct jobs



CHAPTER 5

05 Four kinds of export city

Each type earns its exports from a different source and carries a different risk to the city around it.

The benchmark sorts into four types. They are defined by where the export advantage comes from and by how the zone relates to a city, and each leaves a distinct signature in the ratios of chapter 2.

Metro platform

An anchor exporter and supplier parks plugged into an existing city and a gateway within a short truck run.

EXAMPLES

Tangier and Tanger Med, Kenitra, Casablanca Midparc, Sokhna, Kigali SEZ, Tema, East London IDZ

SIGNATURE IN THE BENCHMARK

About 40 to 73 jobs per ha in supplier parks; US$2m+ of platform capital per ha at Tanger Med; exports to many markets

MAIN RISK

Concentration in a few anchors and idle capacity: Stellantis Kenitra's 2024 output was about 36% of the capacity it reached in 2025

Preference enclave

Labour-intensive assembly built on duty-free access to one market, often inland.

EXAMPLES

Ethiopia's parks including Hawassa and Bole Lemi; Kenya's EPZs

SIGNATURE IN THE BENCHMARK

The highest densities (Hawassa 269 jobs per ha) and lowest capital per job (US$7-16k); US$1-12k of exports per worker

MAIN RISK

Decided abroad: Ethiopia lost 18 firms and 11,400+ jobs after losing AGOA access

Feedstock zone

Processing of a domestic raw material held at home by geology or by a ban.

EXAMPLES

Nkok, GDIZ, PIA, OCP at Jorf Lasfar and Safi, Dangote at Lekki

SIGNATURE IN THE BENCHMARK

High exports per ha (Nkok about US$235k); 15 to 62 jobs per ha; US$59-92k of investment per job

MAIN RISK

Domestic policy and commodity prices; leakage of feedstock across land borders

Platform in waiting

A port, or land, built ahead of its tenants.

EXAMPLES

Nador West Med, Dakhla, Ndayane, Bargny-Sendou, East Port Said, Coega, Dawa, Bagamoyo, Akoupé-Zeudji

SIGNATURE IN THE BENCHMARK

Land and quays ahead of tenants: Coega 2 jobs per ha; East Port Said's 5.6m TEU beside an early-stage zone of about 2,000 jobs; Nador West Med before its first terminal

MAIN RISK

Sequencing and carrying cost: land and quays are paid for years before the jobs arrive

A place can move between types. Tanger Med began as a platform in waiting when the port opened in 2007; the Renault plant, inaugurated in 2012, and its suppliers made the complex a metro platform. Hawassa is a preference enclave inside a fast-growing regional city, and would need a second market to become a metro platform. Nador West Med and Ndayane are platforms in waiting today; their type in ten years depends on the anchor each attracts.

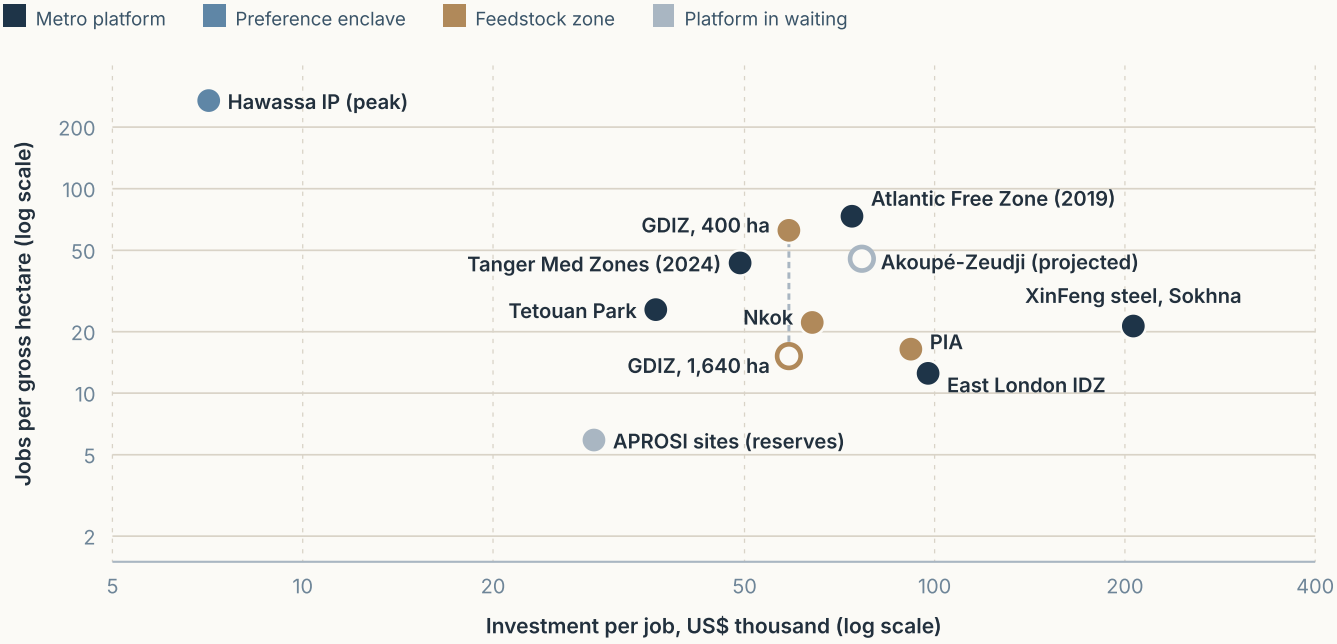
THE TYPES IN THE DATA

Enclaves buy cheap, dense jobs, while feedstock zones and metro platforms spend more per job on less crowded land

EXHIBIT 18

Where both ratios can be computed, the types separate

Jobs per gross hectare against investment per job; hollow markers are projected or master-plan figures



Source: Heirstone analysis of the Heirstone Export City Benchmark 2026 (Exhibit 6) and SCZone (2025) for XinFeng (US$1.65bn, 3.75m sq m, 8,000+ jobs). Bases differ: Hawassa uses public build cost, the Atlantic Free Zone induced investment (2019) and its original 345 ha (42 jobs per ha on 600 ha), Nkok total FDI.

Only ten of the 31 zones publish enough to place them on both axes, one of them on projections, which is itself a finding. Hawassa sits alone at top left: about US$250m of sheds filled with 35,000 workers at the peak, under US$10,000 of build cost per job. Kenya's EPZs, with about US$16,000 of cumulative investment per job, would sit near it if their area were published.

The feedstock zones cluster in the middle, at US$59,000 to US$92,000 per job and 15 to 62 jobs per hectare, depending on the area basis. Tetouan Park, a Moroccan park serving mainly the domestic market, sits just to their left at about US$36,000 per job. Morocco's two metro platforms sit at similar capital per job, US$49,000 to US$74,000, with 42 to 73 jobs per hectare. XinFeng's steel plant at Sokhna shows the capital-heavy end of a metro platform, at about US$206,000 per job.

The platforms in waiting fall to the bottom of the chart. Senegal's APROSI sites have 6 jobs per hectare of land reserves. Coega, with 2 jobs per hectare, publishes no investment total and is not plotted. The chart cannot show the most important variable for a platform in waiting, which is time: the years between the first hectare serviced and the first export shipped.

10 of 31

zones in the benchmark that publish area, jobs and investment

<US$10k

public build cost per job at Hawassa's peak (US$250m, 35,000 workers)

THE HEIRSTONE EXPORT CITY TEST

Six questions to ask before the next hectare is zoned

1. Anchor	A named exporter or cluster with published export volumes
2. Gateway	A deep-water port within about 60 km, open and operating
3. Policy	Export case does not rest on a foreign preference (full) or rests on a domestic ban (half)
4. Home input	A domestic input secured by geology, policy or an integrated supplier base
5. Density	40+ jobs per gross ha (full); 15 to 40 (half); under 15 (empty)
6. City	An established city within commuting range that has absorbed workers, or a new town delivered to plan

The test turns the evidence of chapters 1 to 4 into six questions an investment agency, a developer or a lender can answer from public data. Thresholds come from the benchmark: Tanger Med's zones sit 39 to 63 km from the port and reach 48 jobs per hectare. A zone that fails the anchor and density tests is a platform in waiting, whatever its quay length.

EXHIBIT 19

Tangier passes five tests and partly meets the sixth; most other zones cannot be scored on at least one test from public data

Heirstone export city test applied to thirteen places in the benchmark

● meets ◑ partly ○ does not – no public data

PLACE	ANCHOR	GATEWAY	POLICY	HOME INPUT	DENSITY	CITY	BINDING CONSTRAINT
● Tangier and Tanger Med	●	●	●	◑	●	●	Housing near the plants; filling installed lines
● Kenitra (Atlantic Free Zone)	●	◑	●	◑	●	●	Supplier land: under 45 ha free in 2019, purchasing target up 8.6x
● Sokhna (SCZone)	●	●	●	–	–	–	Zone area and worker housing data not yet published; heavy-industry mix (petrochemicals, steel)
● Ethiopia's parks (Hawassa)	◑	○	○	–	●	◑	Market access; Hawassa at 30-40% of capacity
● Kenya EPZs	◑	–	○	–	–	–	Three-quarters of jobs in AGOA apparel
● Kigali SEZ	◑	○	–	–	–	●	Land: about 400 ha of expansion planned
● Nkok	●	●	◑	●	◑	◑	Diversifying beyond wood (84 of 144 firms)
● GDIZ	◑	●	◑	●	◑	◑	Filling 1,640 ha towards a 300,000-job target
● PIA Adétikopé	◑	●	◑	●	◑	◑	Density: 16 jobs per ha
● Lekki (Dangote)	●	●	●	–	–	◑	No published employment for the anchors
● Dakar: Diamniadio, Ndayane	○	◑	◑	◑	○	◑	Gas for industry awaits investment decisions
● Coega	◑	●	–	–	○	◑	2 jobs per ha on 11,500 ha
● Nador West Med	○	◑	–	◑	–	–	An anchor tenant before the port opens

Source: Heirstone assessment based on the evidence and sources in chapters 1 to 4 and Exhibit 6. Gateway for Kenitra is scored partly because its exports ship through Tanger Med; for Ndayane and Nador West Med because their ports open in 2026 to 2028. Policy for Senegal reflects pending investment decisions on domestic gas.

18 of the 78 cells cannot be filled from public information. For an investor comparing sites, missing data is itself a cost: the zones that publish customs exports, direct jobs and developed hectares are easier to underwrite, and those numbers cost an authority little to release.

CHAPTER 6

06

North Africa and Sub-Saharan Africa

North Africa holds the continent's most complete export city, in northern Morocco, and its largest single zone authority, in Egypt's SCZone. Sub-Saharan Africa splits between francophone feedstock zones on the Gulf of Guinea, preference enclaves in the east and a set of platforms still waiting for tenants. We found no comparable published zone-level data for Algeria, Tunisia or Libya.

EXHIBIT 20

Morocco's export platforms run down the coast from Tanger Med to Safi

Ports, zones and anchor plants; colour shows type of export city



Source: Tanger Med Zones; CDG; IGAPE (2025); Nador West Med SA via Le360 (2026); OpenStreetMap (port and town positions). Town positions are approximate host-town locations. Dakhla Atlantique (1,650 ha, MAD 12.4bn, delivery due end-2028) lies about 1,700 km south-west of Tanger Med in a straight line and is not shown.

NORTH AFRICA

Morocco is filling a system it has built; Egypt's SCZone has drawn about US$35bn and 208,000 direct jobs to four industrial zones

Morocco. The next increment of exports will come mainly from filling installed capacity and supplier land. Stellantis Kenitra added capacity for 350,000 mild-hybrid engines and 204,000 charging units a year alongside its vehicle lines, employs 3,500 people and plans more than 3,000 additional jobs. Its purchasing target, over EUR 6bn from Moroccan suppliers by 2030, is about 8.6 times today's, while the Atlantic Free Zone had less than 45 ha left in 2019 and a 100 ha extension under negotiation.

Aerospace is the next cluster to watch. Midparc at Nouaceur covers 125 ha, with 50 ha more planned, and Safran will invest EUR 350m in a LEAP-1A engine assembly and test complex there, creating 900 direct jobs by 2030. Aerospace exports grew from under MAD 1bn in 2004 to MAD 26.45bn in 2024. Sector employment is reported at between 17,000 (2024) and over 26,000 (2025), depending on the source.

Nador West Med opens its first terminal at the end of 2026 with a 700 ha first-phase zone, an LNG terminal of 5 bcm a year and a target of 50,000 direct jobs by 2035. Dakhla Atlantique, a MAD 12.4bn (about US$1.3bn) port on 1,650 ha in a province of about 195,000 people at the 2024 census, is due for delivery at the end of 2028. Both are platforms in waiting; Tangier's record suggests the industrial base follows the port by years.

Egypt. SCZone covers about 461 km2, with four industrial zones and six ports. Sokhna has drawn the capital: Chinese investors brought more than US$4bn in the three years to 2025, according to the SCZone chairman, TEDA-Egypt is extending its 7 km2 allocation towards about 10 km2, and 212 plants were operating in September 2026, with 176 more under construction. Qantara West has the most jobs per dollar of the four. For housing and transport along the canal, the two require different plans.

8.6x

increase in Stellantis's Moroccan purchasing targeted by 2030 (EUR 0.7bn to over EUR 6bn)

900

direct jobs at Safran's EUR 350m LEAP engine plant at Midparc by 2030

US$7.1bn

investment attracted by SCZone in FY2025/26, a record for the zone, as stated by its chairman in May 2026

EXHIBIT 21

Inside SCZone, Sokhna holds 95% of the investment and Qantara West a third of the jobs

SCZone industrial zones: cumulative investment, projects and direct jobs as published in June 2026

INDUSTRIAL ZONE	INVESTMENT, US$M	PROJECTS	DIRECT JOBS	US$M PER PROJECT	JOBS PER US$1M	NAMED PROJECTS
Sokhna	33,100	547	133,000+	60.5	4.0	Red Sea Petrochemicals (US$7.5bn), XinFeng steel (US$1.65bn), Sailun tyres (US$1bn)
Qantara West	1,500	52	~72,000	28.8	48.0	Eroglu carton and packaging plant (US$175m, Jan 2026)
East Port Said	367	7	~2,000	52.4	5.4	Beside a 5.6m TEU port (2026, as stated)
East Ismailia, phase 1	~59	4	900+	14.8	15.3	Phase 1 only
Four zones	**~35,000**	**610**	**~208,000**	**57.4**	**5.9**	

Source: Egypt Today citing the Cabinet Media Center infographic (2 June 2026); Egypt Today (2021) and SCZone (2025) for the named projects; SCZone (January 2026); Spill News citing the SCZone chairman (May 2026). Per-project and per-job ratios: **Heirstone analysis.**

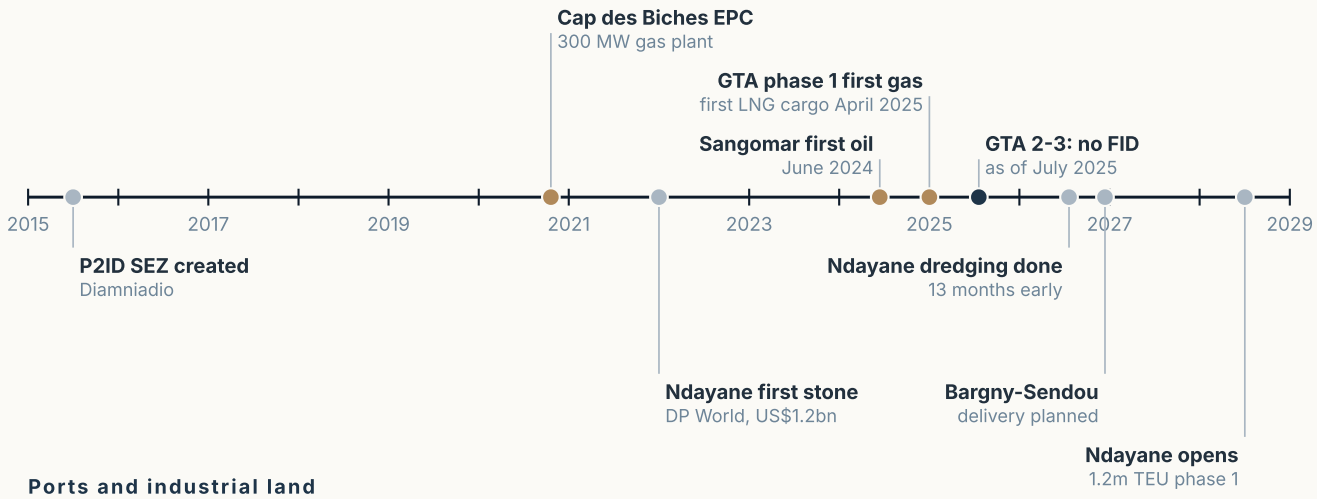
FRANCOPHONE WEST AND CENTRAL AFRICA

Senegal is building port-side industrial land ahead of the gas meant to power it

EXHIBIT 22

Oil and LNG exports started on time; the domestic gas phases and the new port follow later

Senegal: hydrocarbon milestones (above) and port and industrial-land milestones (below), 2015 to 2029



Source: Woodside; Policy Center for the New South (May 2025); S&P Global Commodity Insights (14 July 2025); Enerdata (April 2021); Maritimafrica (January 2022, July 2026); Le Soleil (April 2026); APROSI. Positions within a year are approximate.

Senegal. Sangomar, 82% Woodside and 18% Petrosen, produced 16.9m barrels in 2024 against an 11.7m target, and GTA's first phase shipped its first LNG cargo in April 2025. Both export offshore. Domestic gas for power and industry depends on GTA's second and third phases, of 5 and 10 mtpa, where Petrosen's chief executive saw no visibility on an investment decision in July 2025, and on Yakaar-Teranga, where a decision was targeted for 2025. Bargny-Sendou's 480 ha port zone, with about 100 plots of 2 ha, is due at the end of 2026, and DP World's US$1.2bn Ndayane port opens in 2028 with 1.2m TEU of first-phase capacity. Tenants counting on cheap gas should model the dates.

Côte d'Ivoire. Akoupé-Zeudji PK24, north of Abidjan, covers 1,000 ha; by February 2026, 284 ha in 367 lots had been allocated to 173 companies, of which 67 were operating, with EUR 875m (about US$989m at US$1.13 per euro) of projected investment and 12,887 potential jobs. ARISE Ivoire took a block of 329 ha in 2020, according to Ivorian press.

Benin, Togo and Gabon. GDIZ has mobilised EUR 1.3bn on a 1,640 ha plan, with capacity for 40,000 t of fibre and 24m garments a year. PIA had 25 partner companies, 12 operating, 6,580 direct jobs and over CFA 350bn (about US$600m) of cumulative investment after five years, and targets 15,000 to 20,000 jobs by 2030. ARISE IIP lists Cameroon among platforms under development.

1.4x

Ndayane's first-phase capacity relative to Dakar's 2025 container volume

67 of 173

allocated firms operating at Akoupé-Zeudji (February 2026)

144%

Sangomar's 2024 output against target (16.9m barrels)

ANGLOPHONE AND EAST AFRICA

Kigali shows a zone can export without a port; Lagos and the Eastern Cape show a port does not guarantee a dense zone

Rwanda. Kigali SEZ hosts more than 230 industries and over 20,000 jobs, up from 3,124 in 2017, and exported about US$290m of processed goods in 2025, about 6.9% of Rwanda's US$4.2bn of exports. Ethiopia's whole park network exported 2.5% of its country's total. Kigali has no port; it has the capital's labour market, and the government planned in 2023 to add nearly 400 ha.

Ethiopia. IPDC, set up in December 2014, runs 13 parks that are to become special economic zones, and claims 200+ investors and 100,000+ jobs. In 2022 it reported 57,000 jobs against a 75,000 target and about 5,000 layoffs after the AGOA suspension. The FY2025/26 export record of US$266.9m shows the parks can recover; the 2.5% share shows how far they remain from carrying the export base.

Kenya. EPZA counted 101 gazetted zones, 174 enterprises and 72,034 jobs in March 2024, against 91 zones, 157 enterprises and 66,044 jobs a year earlier. Cumulative investment per job is about US$16,000, among the lowest we measured. The exposure is the market: three-quarters of the jobs depend on one trade programme, which KPMG reports was renewed to the end of 2026.

Tanzania. Bagamoyo, a US$10bn port and economic zone project set up in a 2013 partnership with China Merchants, stalled in 2019. TISEZA lists four flagship zones, and ARISE IIP says Kwala Industrial Park will host 200+ industries and 50,000+ jobs.

Nigeria. NEPZA reports more than 400 free zones, 5,800 enterprises and 250,000 jobs, while its own news reported NGN 11.1bn of remittances from the zones over the three years to June 2024. Lagos Free Zone, integrated with Lekki Deep Sea Port, cites US$2.7bn of employed capital and tenants including BASF, Colgate-Palmolive and Kellogg's. Lekki's value sits in two capital-heavy anchors whose employment is not published.

Ghana. Tema EPZ (480 ha) sits in the port city, while GFZA also lists Sekondi (890 ha), Shama (1,133 ha) and the Ashanti Technology Park (445 ha). Dawa, the private land-first project, had six firms in 2021.

South Africa. The export city is led by carmakers. South Africa exported 408,224 vehicles in 2025, up 4.4%, and vehicle manufacturing employed about 115,000 people, according to naamsa. Coega, beside the R10bn Port of Ngqura, reported 55 operating investors and 19,199 jobs created in FY2021/22 on its 11,500 ha; East London IDZ, serving Mercedes-Benz suppliers, has 40+ investors, R8bn of private investment and 5,000+ jobs on 400+ ha.

The Gulf. Gulf capital appears in this story mainly as a port operator: DP World has run Dakar's container terminal since 2008 and is building Ndayane under concession.

6.9%

share of Rwanda's exports from Kigali SEZ in 2025, against 2.5% for Ethiopia's parks

6.4x

growth in Kigali SEZ jobs between 2017 and 2025

408,224

vehicles exported by South Africa in 2025, up 4.4%

US$16k

cumulative investment per job in Kenya's EPZs, among the lowest we measured

CHAPTER 7

07 Decisions for the next zone

The evidence points the same way for every party: put diligence and public money where the capital and the risk sit, in the industrial platform and in the city that supplies its workers.

FOR

Governments and investment agencies

Publish customs exports, direct jobs, developed hectares and firms operating for each zone every year. 18 of the 78 cells in our export city test are blank for want of such numbers.

Price the policy behind the export case. Ethiopia's parks lost 18 firms after a foreign decision; Benin's cashew ban, by one analyst's estimate, left nearly 70% of the crop crossing land borders.

Rank incentives by jobs per dollar as well as dollars: across the zones we could measure, jobs per US$1m run from 3 to 140, and SCZone's Qantara West reaches 48.

FOR

Port authorities

Report volumes that serve local industry separately from transshipment. Tanger Med's TEU rose 8.4% in a year its vehicle exports fell 12%.

Invest in the truck gate and the road to the zones; Tanger Med's next phase lifts truck capacity above one million a year.

Treat a new quay as the start of the zone's timetable: Tanger Med's port opened in 2007 and its Renault anchor in 2012. The zones beside East Port Said and Nador West Med are at that first stage now.

FOR

Zone developers

Sell serviced supplier land near the anchor. Supplier parks reach about 40 to 73 jobs per hectare against 21 at the Renault plant.

Phase land to tenants. Akoupé-Zeudji had 67 of 173 allocated firms operating; Dawa six firms on 8,903 ha.

Test every job target against achieved density before it is announced: 183 jobs per hectare at GDIZ would exceed every zone but Hawassa.

FOR

Manufacturers

Choose zones on the six tests, starting with the gateway and the labour market within commuting range.

Model trade-preference and feedstock-policy scenarios; Kenya's EPZs lost 5,337 planned openings amid uncertainty over one renewal.

Where gas or power is the reason to locate, check that the supply has a final investment decision behind it.

FOR

DFIs and investors

Underwrite the platform and its links, where most of the capital sits, with covenants on tenant mix and capacity use.

Treat zones that rest on one foreign preference as carrying event risk; build in diversification milestones.

Make commuter transport and housing in the existing city a condition of platform finance, alongside the zone itself.

FOR

City planners and housing agencies

Plan for the workforce in the nearest existing city first: Tangier counted 1.28 million residents in 2024 while Chrafate had delivered 420 homes.

Size homes, schools and transport from the export target: each US$100m implies 6,700 to 10,000 workers.

Build a new town only when an anchor is committed and the commute is long; see our companion report *Factories need beds*.

A REPORTING STANDARD

Eight numbers every export zone should publish

Most of the analysis in this report had to be built from fragments, such as a key-figures sheet from one zone and a ministerial infographic for another. Each missing number becomes an assumption in an investor's model.

A common annual return of eight numbers would let investment agencies compare their zones with competitors, lenders monitor the assets they finance and city governments plan for the workforce before it arrives.

How Heirstone works on export cities

We help governments, zone developers, investors and manufacturers decide where to build and what it is worth: market and demand studies for industrial and logistics land, highest-and-best-use and site selection, feasibility and business models (DCF, IRR, NPV and Monte Carlo testing), masterplanning and phasing, and benchmarking of the kind in this report.

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1 **Developed and gross hectares**
GDIZ shows 62 or 15 jobs per hectare depending on which area is used; the Atlantic Free Zone 73 or 42.

2 **Direct jobs at year end**
Several authorities publish cumulative or "created" jobs, or mix direct and indirect, which makes zones impossible to compare.

3 **Customs exports by zone**
Tanger Med publishes business volume and Morocco's Office des Changes exports by sector; no source we found gives exports by zone.

4 **Public and private investment, port and platform**
Tanger Med's split of US$1.9bn and US$6.39bn made chapter 1 possible, yet even it does not show how US$5.25bn of public money divides.

5 **Firms signed, allocated and operating**
Akoupé-Zeudji publishes all three (173 allocated, 67 operating); most zones publish one.

6 **Capacity in use for the anchors**
Stellantis Kenitra and Hawassa show how much export growth can come from existing lines.

7 **Where workers live and how they travel**
No zone in the benchmark publishes it, yet it decides whether a new town or a bus contract is needed.

8 **Local sourcing**
Renault Group Maroc publishes integration and sourcing (65.5%, EUR 2.39bn in 2024); it is the best measure of supplier-park demand.

NOTES, SOURCES AND DEFINITIONS

Notes

Definitions

Zone: an export processing zone, free zone, special economic zone, industrial park or industrial acceleration zone as designated by its authority. **Gross hectares:** the zone area as published, which may include undeveloped land. **Jobs:** direct jobs unless stated; Nkok and some Ethiopian figures include indirect jobs or are authority claims. **Business volume:** turnover of zone firms, including domestic sales and logistics, used by Tanger Med in place of customs exports. **TEU:** twenty-foot equivalent unit. **AGOA:** the US African Growth and Opportunity Act.

Method

The Heirstone Export City Benchmark compiles the latest published figures for 31 zones and zone programmes. Ratios divide published figures and are labelled Heirstone analysis; where years or bases differ between numerator and denominator we say so. Exchange rates: World Bank annual averages for the dirham (MAD 9.35 per US$ in 2025, 9.94 in 2024, 9.62 in 2019); for other currencies the rates stated in the research base (KSh 129 per US$ at mid-2025; CFA franc 580 per US$ and US$1.13 per euro, 2025 averages; CFA 605 per US$ for 2023; ZAR 16.4 per US$, 2025, approximate; NGN about 1,530 per US$, first quarter of 2025). Local-currency series across years are nominal and not adjusted for devaluation unless stated. Where sources conflict we give the range or the more conservative figure. Map positions are approximate host-town locations.

Use of this report

This report is published for general information. It is not investment, legal or valuation advice and should not be relied on as such. It uses only public information. Images are illustrative.

1 WHERE THE MONEY WENT

Tanger Med Port Authority, port activity reports 2022 to 2025; Tanger Med Group, Key figures 2024 (USD), Sept 2025, and Communication financière, 29 Apr 2026; Tanger Med Group website; TelQuel (13 Apr 2026); Morocco World News (Apr 2026); Le Matin and Le360 quoting Nador West Med SA (29 Jan 2026); Spill News citing the SCZone chairman (5 May 2026); Egypt Today citing the Cabinet Media Center (2 Jun 2026); Tanger Med, IFC and MIGA joint release (4 Nov 2024); Maritimafrica (16 Nov 2025); Office des Changes via Hespress, Le360, TelQuel, Médias24 and FNH (2022 to 2026); World Bank WDI PA.NUS.FCRF; Stellantis (16 Jul 2025); TelQuel (5 Aug 2025); Médias24 (21 Jan 2025); Challenge.ma (2026); Journal de l'Automobile citing Inovev (12 Nov 2025).

2 HECTARES, JOBS AND EXPORTS

Tanger Med Zones zone pages; CDG Group; Médias24 (4 Jul 2019); Automotive Manufacturing Solutions (2025); IGAPE (Oct 2025); Sudan Tribune (2016); Cepheus Capital, Ethiopia industrial parks data pack (2019); Texfash (2022); SCZone (2025); Egypt Today (2021); Embassy of the Czech Republic in Abuja (2021); ThisDay (2024); SAOGA, Coega IDZ; Engineering News (2009); Construction Review (2017); The Citizen (2019); OpenStreetMap (map positions); IPDC; EPZA Kenya; The Star (18 Dec 2025); KNBS Economic Survey 2025 via Kenyan Wall Street; The New Times (2023, 2026); The EastAfrican (2017); ARISE IIP; US ITA (7 Mar 2024); Government of Benin (27 Nov 2023); Bird Story Agency via AllAfrica (28 Aug 2026); Togonews via AllAfrica (2026); Team France Export (2 Mar 2026); APROSI; Le Soleil (22 Apr 2026); Maritimafrica (2022, 2026); Lagos Free Zone; GFZA; Ghana News Agency (2021); Dawa City Limited (2020); SAnews (13 Oct 2022); East London IDZ; TISEZA.

3 ONE DECISION, ONE YEAR

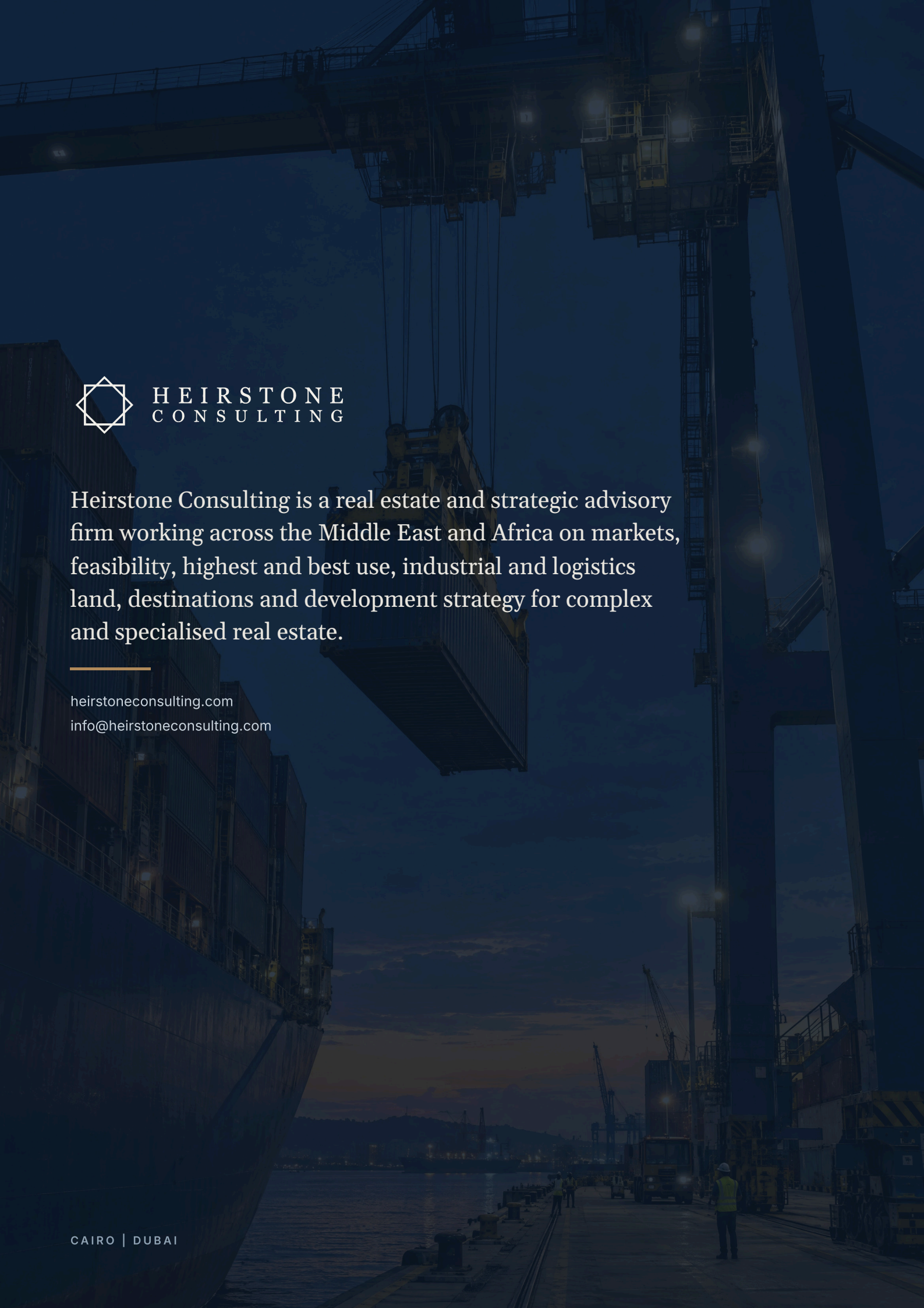
Al Jazeera (2022); Trade Preferences Extension Act of 2015 (Public Law 114-27); KPMG TaxNewsFlash (Feb 2026); Addis Fortune (12 May 2025); Capital Ethiopia (22 Jul 2024); Kana TV (28 Jul 2026); The Reporter Ethiopia (3 Sep 2022); Business Daily Africa (17 Nov 2025, 3 Sep 2026); World Bank, Gabon Economic Update 2024; Ecofin Agency (11 Jun 2026; Sep 2025); APA News; Morocco World News (Sep 2025); Peoples Gazette (15 Jun 2026); BusinessDay citing NBS (20 Jun 2025).

4 THE TOWN THAT DID NOT COME

Al Omrane Group model paper (GLTN Arab Land Initiative); Médias24 (8 Oct 2013); Le Matin (15 Oct 2025); HCP, RGPH 2024 legal population; World Bank, Hawassa Industrial Park Community Impact Evaluation (2019); Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority; African Business (2023); ADM, PROGEP capitalisation note (2019); Kiel Institute, KCG Working Paper 26 (Jun 2023); African Energy Week (4 Jul 2025).

5 TO 7 TYPES, TEST, REGIONS AND DECISIONS

As above, plus Woodside; Policy Center for the New South (12 May 2025); S&P Global Commodity Insights (14 Jul 2025); Enerdata (Apr 2021); North Africa Post (2025); Safran via Business Wire (14 Oct 2025); Hespress FR (7 Jul 2024); Connection Ivoirienne (25 Nov 2020); SCZone; Enterprise (7 Sep 2026); NEPZA; naamsa, December 2025 new vehicle sales release (2026); The Reporter Ethiopia (2024); Khass an Misr (aboutmsr.com, 2025) for Chinese investment and TEDA-Egypt at Sokhna.



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